CURRICULUM BOOK

Cash to Company

GRADE 5

Curriculum Book

Money, pricing, and profit

Cost, price, profit. Real numbers. Real customers.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Grade 5 - Curriculum Book

Cost, price, profit. Real numbers. Real customers. This book is part of the Cash to Company K-12 program - a financial literacy and entrepreneurship curriculum aligned to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, and CASEL standards.

Ten fully fleshed lessons spanning the year. *Each lesson is built to pass the picks-up-Monday test: a teacher with no prior prep should be able to read this Sunday night and teach it Monday morning. Standards are cited at the benchmark level. Differentiation notes are specific and actionable. Vocabulary is included for each lesson. Time blocks default to 50 minutes (a standard upper-elementary period); longer blocks are flagged.*

Lessons are sampled across the year so the full arc is visible:

1. (Week 1) Cash V1 launch + Day 1 Idea Sentence
2. (Week 4) Brainstorm, Cluster, Vote — Picking a Real Idea
3. (Week 7) Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web — Capstone Lock-In
4. (Week 10) Cost, Revenue, Profit — A Lemonade Stand on Paper
5. (Week 13) Setting a Price with a Target Margin
6. (Week 17) The 30-Second Elevator Pitch
7. (Week 20) Spot the Trick — Persuasion Techniques in Real Ads
8. (Week 24) Fact vs. Opinion in Ad Claims
9. (Week 31) Inventory Tracker — Practice Day Before the Market
10. (Week 36) Classroom Market Day + Post-Market Debrief

Money in, money out, money left

Cost, price, profit - in real numbers.

Lesson 1 — Day 1 Idea Sentence (Cash V1 launch)

"*Revenue is loud. What's left is what you keep.*"

- CASH, GRADE 5

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Where do business ideas come from? **Topic area:** Course launch · idea generation · evidence framing **Strand focus:** PSIG, BAVC

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Write a "Day 1 Idea Sentence" — one sentence naming a business idea, who would buy it, and why someone would pay.
- Distinguish between an *idea* and *evidence* using two concrete examples.

Standards alignment

- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-4:** Identify factors that influence the level of income earned. *(Adapted to "what makes prices what they are.")*
- **CCSS-ELA SL.5.4:** Report on a topic in an organized manner.

- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Identifying one's own assumptions.

Materials

- Cash Video #1 ("Profit Is What's Left") — 2:30. Use printed transcript if no projector.
- One Capstone Journal (composition notebook) per student.
- Two index cards per student.
- A small box labeled "Day 1 Ideas" for collecting cards.
- Sentence frame projected: "*My idea is* ***_. The customer is . They would pay because*** *__.*"

Vocabulary

- **Idea** — something you think could work but have not checked yet.
- **Customer** — a specific person who would pay for what you make or do.
- **Evidence** — something you saw, heard, or counted that helps you check your idea.

Procedure

1. Engage — Watch Cash V1 (~7 min)

Play Cash Video #1. Post on the board while students watch:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*What is one business idea you could imagine running this year?*"

Pair-share for two minutes. Cold-call two students. Surface the year's spine question: "*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*"

2. Explore — Idea vs. Evidence Sort (~10 min)

Read aloud six statements. After each, students give a thumbs-up if it is *evidence* and thumbs-sideways if it is just an *idea*.

- "Kids love candy." (idea)

- "Three of my friends bought a lollipop on Monday." (evidence)
- "Everyone wants slime." (idea)
- "Two third-graders asked me to make them keychains last week." (evidence)
- "People at my school will buy bracelets." (idea)
- "I sold five bracelets at the school fair last month." (evidence)

Ask: "*What is the difference?*" Sharpen on the board: an idea is what you think; evidence is what you saw, heard, or counted.

3. Explain — The Year's Norm (~7 min)

State the year's norm out loud: "*In this room, when you say something about a customer, you will be asked: how do you know? You will ask each other this. Get used to it.*"

Define the three vocabulary words. Add them to the Vocabulary Spine page in the Capstone Journal.

4. Apply — Write the Day 1 Idea Sentence (~18 min)

In the Capstone Journal, students write three things:

1. **Day 1 Idea Sentence.** Use the frame: "*My idea is* ***_. The customer is . They would pay because*** *__.*"
2. One thing they are least sure about in their sentence.
3. A 1-to-5 prediction: how wrong will this be by Week 8? (1 = totally right, 5 = completely wrong.)

Confer with five students while others write. Read each sentence; ask one sharpening question.

5. Close — Pin and Predict (~8 min)

Each student copies the Day 1 Idea Sentence onto an index card with their name and prediction. Drop in the box. Tell them you will hand them back in Week 8 to see how the idea changed.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Provide the sentence frame on a sticky note. Allow native-language drafting; require English on the index card. Pre-teach *idea, customer, evidence* with cognates (Spanish: *idea, cliente, evidencia*).
- **IEP/504.** Allow voice-recorded answers on a phone with student transcribing later. Reduce prediction to a check (right / wrong) instead of 1–5.
- **Advanced.** Push for specificity — "kids" is too broad. Ask: *which kids? what age? at what moment would they buy?* Have them write a second sentence: "*What would have to be true for this to actually work?*"

Assessment

Formative: Walk during the writing time; watch which students struggle to name a customer. **Summative:** The Day 1 Idea Sentence is filed; will be compared to the Week 8 Capstone Lock-In for one of the year's reflection prompts.

Closure

Same as #5 above.

Teacher notes

- Some students will freeze on naming a customer. Coach: "*Who is the first person you would tell about this?*" That person is usually a customer.
- A student says "I don't have an idea." Coach: "*What is something you are good at? What is something annoying that nobody fixes?*" Read the Skills + Hobbies + Needs framing if helpful.
- **Sensitivity:** Do not ask students about family money or family businesses. If a student names a parent's business, accept it; redirect toward "what does this business do for customers?" — not "how much does your family make?"

Lesson 2 — Brainstorm, Cluster, Vote: Picking a Real Idea

> **TRY THIS**
>
> **Cost it out**
>
> Make the thing you want to sell. Write down every supply you used and what each one cost. Add it up. That's your cost per one.

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Where do business ideas come from? **Topic area:** Idea generation · structured brainstorming **Strand focus:** PSIG

Objectives

- Generate at least 8 business ideas from a single problem prompt.
- Cluster ideas into 3 categories.
- Vote on one as a "real-sounding" pick with a written reason.

Standards alignment

- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-3:** Describe entrepreneurship and how people start small businesses.
- **CCSS-ELA W.5.1:** Write opinion pieces supporting a point of view with reasons.
- **NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-2:** Generate and compare multiple possible solutions to a problem.

Materials

- Sticky notes (8 per student).
- A problem prompt projected: "*Kids at our school's after-school program are bored between activities. What could a small business do to help?*"
- Three poster sheets labeled "*Add value,*" "*Save time,*" "*Make life nicer.*"
- Capstone Journal.

Vocabulary

- **Brainstorm** — generating lots of ideas without judging them yet.
- **Cluster** — grouping similar ideas together to see patterns.
- **Vote** — picking one to move forward, with a reason.

Procedure

1. Engage — Bad Brainstorm Story (~5 min)

Tell a 90-second story: a kid with "the one perfect idea" stops thinking after the first try. Hook: most great ideas come from the seventh or eighth try. The first three are usually obvious.

2. Brainstorm Phase (~10 min)

Project the prompt. Each student writes one idea per sticky note, fast, no judging. Goal: at least 8. Set a 7-minute timer. No talking during brainstorm. Silly ideas count.

3. Cluster Phase (~10 min)

Each student walks to the front and posts their stickies on one of the three poster sheets — choosing which category each idea fits. Read titles aloud as students post.

4. Vote Phase (~15 min)

Each student picks one idea (their own or someone else's). In the Capstone Journal, write:

- *My picked idea:* _____
- *Why I picked it:* (3 reasons.)
- *What would have to be true for this to actually work?* (1 sentence.)

5. Close — One-Sentence Share-Out (~10 min)

Five volunteers share their idea + reason. Class gives one "I notice" each (no judging, only noticing).

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Allow native-language stickies with English summary on the back. Sentence frames for the journal entry.
- **IEP/504.** Reduce target from 8 to 5 ideas. Pre-printed journal template with sections labeled.
- **Advanced.** Generate ideas in three "modes" — easy, expensive, silly — and explain how the mode shaped the idea. Push for one "I don't think this will work but it's fun to think about" idea.

Assessment

Formative: Walk during brainstorm; check that students are writing fast and not judging. **Summative:** The picked idea + 3 reasons feeds Unit 1's Capstone artifact.

Closure

Same as #5.

Teacher notes

- A student writes one idea and freezes. Coach: "*What is the silliest idea you could think of? Write that next.*" Silly ideas unblock real ones.
- The cluster step often surprises students — many will see that their "unique" idea is actually similar to others. That is a feature.
- **Sensitivity:** Avoid problem prompts that touch on food insecurity or family money. The "after-school boredom" prompt is safe; "how to save money on groceries" is not.

Lesson 3 — Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web (Capstone Lock-In)

WORDS TO KNOW

Cost
Money out - what it takes to make or deliver one unit.

Price
Money in - what the customer pays for one unit.

Profit
Price minus cost. What is left after costs are paid.

Margin
Profit shown as a percentage of price.

Revenue
Total money in across many sales - loud, but not the same as profit.

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 60 minutes (block — or 2 × 30) **Unit:** 1 — Where do business ideas come from? **Topic area:** Self-knowledge applied to entrepreneurship · Capstone selection **Strand focus:** BAVC, PSIG

Objectives

- Complete a Skills + Hobbies + Needs web with at least 3 entries in each section.
- Circle two business ideas the web suggests.
- Lock in one Capstone idea with a written reason.

Standards alignment

- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-3:** Describe entrepreneurship and how people start small businesses.
- **CCSS-ELA W.5.1:** Write opinion pieces supporting a point of view with reasons.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Identify one's own skills and interests.

Materials

- Skills + Hobbies + Needs web template (one per student).
- Capstone Journal.
- A printed list of "Capstone-friendly" idea categories (food, craft, tutoring, content, service, repair, events).

Vocabulary

- **Skill** — something you can do well or are getting better at.
- **Hobby** — something you do for fun, not for money.
- **Need** — a problem someone has that nobody has solved well yet.

Procedure

1. Engage — Cash's Three Buckets (~7 min)

Draw three overlapping circles on the board: SKILLS, HOBBIES, NEEDS. Tell students: "*Most real business ideas live where these three circles overlap.*" Give one example: a kid who is good at drawing (skill), loves anime (hobby), and notices that classmates want custom phone wallpapers (need) → a custom-wallpaper service.

2. Fill the Web (~20 min)

Students fill in their template. Three entries minimum per section. Coach pace: skills first, hobbies second, needs third. The needs section is the hardest; encourage students to think about complaints they hear at home, on the bus, or at recess.

After 15 minutes, students circle two ideas the web suggests. Examples: "I'm good at math + I like helping + my brother needs help with multiplication = a tutoring service."

3. Talk Before Lock-In (~10 min)

In pairs, students share their two ideas. Partners ask one question each: "*Who would actually pay for this?*" and "*What would it cost to start?*" No correcting; only asking.

4. Capstone Lock-In (~15 min)

In the Capstone Journal, students write:

- **My Capstone idea: _____**
- **Customer (one specific group): _____**
- **Why I think they would pay: _____**
- **What I will need to learn this year to do this well: _____**

Confer with as many students as possible. Watch for "everyone" or "kids" as customers — push for specificity.

5. Close — Pin to the Wall (~8 min)

Each student writes their Capstone idea on a 4×6 card and posts it on the "Capstone Wall" at the back of the room. Cards stay up all year. Students will revisit them at every checkpoint.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Sentence frames for the lock-in. Allow native-language brainstorming. Cognates: *habilidad* (skill), *pasatiempo* (hobby), *necesidad* (need).
- **IEP/504.** Pre-fill one example in each section of the template so the student can pattern-match. Reduce circled ideas to one if needed.
- **Advanced.** Add a fourth section: "Constraints I have" (no oven at home, can only work weekends). Push the student to build an idea that respects constraints — that is closer to real entrepreneurship.

Assessment

Formative: Walk during the web. Watch for students whose three sections are unbalanced (lots of hobbies, no needs). **Summative:** The Capstone Lock-In is the Unit 1 anchor artifact.

Closure

Same as #5.

Teacher notes

- Optional pivot windows in Weeks 9 and 19 let students switch ideas. Lock-in here is real but not final.
- A student says "I don't have any skills." Coach: "*What is something you can do that a kindergartener cannot?*" That gets them moving.
- **Sensitivity:** Some students will list a parent's job as a "skill" or list "money" as a "need." Both are fine. Redirect from family-money detail toward "what could you offer that helps that need?"

Lesson 4 — Cost, Revenue, Profit: A Lemonade Stand on Paper

> **MATH MOMENT**
>
> **Profit per unit**
>
> Cost per one: $1.40. Price per one: $4.00. Profit per one is price minus cost. What's left? If you sell 12, what's the total profit?

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 2 — The math of one sale **Topic area:** Per-sale math · core financial vocabulary **Strand focus:** MFL

Objectives

- Calculate cost, revenue, and profit for a hypothetical lemonade stand at three different sales volumes.
- Explain in 2–3 sentences why profit is *what is left* rather than total sales.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-Math 5.NBT.B.7:** Add, subtract, multiply, and divide decimals.
- **CCSS-Math 5.OA.A.1:** Use parentheses, brackets, or braces in numerical expressions. *(Used in profit formula.)*

- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 8 Benchmark:** Income from self-employment is not the same as profit.

Materials

- "Lemonade Lab" worksheet (provided).
- Calculator (optional — but allowed throughout).
- Whiteboard with three columns: COST · REVENUE · PROFIT.
- Cash V2 ("Profit Is What's Left") — 2:30.

Vocabulary

- **Cost** — what you pay to make something.
- **Revenue** — the total money you take in from sales.
- **Profit** — what is left after you subtract cost from revenue.

Procedure

1. Engage — Two Stands, One Truth (~7 min)

Project two scenarios: Stand A makes $50 in sales but spent $48 on supplies. Stand B makes $30 in sales but spent $5 on supplies. Ask: "*Which had a better day?*" Pair-share. Most pick A.

Reveal: A's profit is $2. B's profit is $25. Surface the principle: total sales is loud; profit is true.

2. Explain — The Formula (~5 min)

Write: **Profit = Revenue − Cost.** Walk through each word. *Cost is what you paid; revenue is what you took in; profit is the difference.* Add the three terms to the Vocabulary Spine.

3. We Do — Worked Example (~10 min)

A lemonade stand. Cost per cup: $0.30 (lemons, sugar, cup). Price per cup: $1.00.

- 10 cups: Revenue = $10. Cost = $3. Profit = $7.
- 20 cups: Revenue = $20. Cost = $6. Profit = $14.

- 50 cups: Revenue = $50. Cost = $15. Profit = $35.

Coach: notice profit grows proportionally to volume when costs are variable.

4. You Do — Worksheet (~20 min)

Students compute cost, revenue, and profit for three scenarios:

- A friendship-bracelet stand. Cost per bracelet: $0.50. Price: $2.00. Compute for 5, 10, and 20 sales.
- A custom-keychain service. Cost per keychain: $1.20. Price: $3.50. Compute for 8, 16, and 30 sales.
- A pet-walking afternoon. Cost per walk: $0.50 (treats + bags). Price per walk: $5.00. Compute for 3, 6, and 12 walks.

5. Close — Why Profit Is Not Sales (~8 min)

Exit ticket: "*In your own words, why is 'how much money came in' not the same as profit?*" Two sentences.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Vocabulary card with each term and its formula. Allow calculator without restriction. Pair on the first scenario, independent for the rest. Cognates: *costo, ingresos, ganancia.*
- **IEP/504.** Pre-printed worksheet with columns labeled. Reduce scenarios from 3 to 2. Calculator allowed.
- **Advanced.** Add a "what is the lowest price you could charge and still make money?" question for each scenario. Introduces breakeven informally.

Assessment

Formative: Worksheet performance during work block. Exit ticket clarity.
Summative: Feeds the Pricing Decision artifact at the Unit 2 close.

Closure

Same as #5.

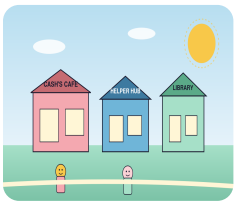
Teacher notes

- A student insists "we got the supplies for free, so cost is zero." Coach: "*If you wanted to do this every week, would you keep getting them for free? What would they cost?*" That moves them past the trap.
- Calculator vs. mental math: at Grade 5, the financial reasoning is the goal. Allow calculators.
- **Sensitivity:** Use only hypothetical scenarios. Do not ask "how much does your family spend on lemonade" or "what does your family pay at the store?"

Lesson 5 — Setting a Price with a Target Margin

CASH ASKS

"*What did they actually say? Tell me one real sentence.*"



PEOPLE YOU CAN ASK

Five real prices

Ask: 'Would you pay $5 for this? $4? $3?' Write what they say. The number people actually pay is the only one that counts.

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 60 minutes (block) **Unit:** 2 — The math of one sale
Topic area: Pricing math · margin reasoning **Strand focus:** MFL

Objectives

- Calculate a price for a product using a target margin (40%).
- Predict total profit at three sales volumes.
- Defend the chosen price in two written sentences.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-Math 5.NBT.B.7:** Add, subtract, multiply, and divide decimals.
- **CCSS-Math 5.NF.B.6:** Solve real-world problems involving multiplication of fractions and mixed numbers.
- **C3 D2.Eco.7.3-5:** Explain how profits influence sellers in markets.

Materials

- Pricing Decision worksheet (provided).
- Calculator.
- Whiteboard.
- Three example products: a $0.30-cost bracelet, a $1.20-cost keychain, a $0.50-cost dog-walk service.

Vocabulary

- **Price** — what the customer pays.
- **Margin** — the part of the price that is not cost. Introduced as "what is left."
- **Target margin** — a margin you decide ahead of time to aim for.

Procedure

1. Engage — The 40% Question (~10 min)

Write on the board: "*If a bracelet costs $0.30 to make, and I want to keep 40% of every sale as profit, what should I charge?*"

Walk through:

- 40% margin means cost is 60% of the price.
- $0.30 = 60% of price.
- Price = $0.30 ÷ 0.60 = $0.50.

Then check: $0.50 − $0.30 = $0.20. Is $0.20 / $0.50 = 40%? Yes. The formula works.

2. Explain — Why Margin Matters (~7 min)

A 40% margin means: every dollar of sales, $0.40 is yours to keep, and $0.60 went back into making more. Higher margin = more money to keep. Lower margin = need more sales to make the same total. Cash's frame: "*Same number of sales, different price, very different day.*"

3. We Do — Two Worked Examples (~10 min)

- Keychain. Cost: $1.20. Target margin: 40%. Price = $1.20 / 0.60 = $2.00.
- Dog-walk. Cost: $0.50. Target margin: 50% (a higher target). Price = $0.50 / 0.50 = $1.00. Then ask: would you charge $1 to walk a dog? Why or why not? Surface that target margin is a starting point, not a final answer.

4. You Do — Pricing Decision (~25 min)

Students fill in the Pricing Decision worksheet for their Capstone idea:

- **Step 1.** List unit cost (estimated honestly).
- **Step 2.** Pick a target margin (30%, 40%, or 50%).
- **Step 3.** Calculate the price.
- **Step 4.** Predict total profit at three sales volumes (low, medium, high — student picks the numbers).
- **Step 5.** Write two sentences: "*I picked this price because* ***. If I priced higher, I think*** *.*"

Confer with 5–6 students. Watch for the "we got it at home" trap; coach.

5. Close — Pair Defense (~8 min)

In pairs, students take turns defending their price in one minute. Partner asks: "*What would happen if you cut your price in half?*" Student answers in one sentence.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Sentence frames for Step 5. Cognates: *precio, margen, ganancia.* Allow calculator with no restriction.

- **IEP/504.** Reduce sales volumes from 3 to 2. Pre-fill Step 1 with one example. Allow voice-recorded Step 5.
- **Advanced.** Add a fourth step: "*What if costs go up 20%? How much do I need to charge to keep my 40% margin?*" This introduces sensitivity analysis.

Assessment

Formative: Worksheet check during work block. **Summative:** Pricing Decision is the Unit 2 anchor artifact.

Closure

Same as #5.

Teacher notes

- A student picks a margin so high the price is unreasonable ($5 for a $0.50-cost bracelet, 90% margin). Coach: "*That is a choice. What do you think will happen?*" Let the math and reality (in Unit 4) teach.
- A student picks too low a price. Same coaching.
- **Sensitivity:** Pricing is a choice, not a moral judgment. Do not say "you are charging too much" or "that is greedy." Say "*What do you think will happen at that price?*"

Lesson 6 — The 30-Second Elevator Pitch

FAMILY TALK

Loud vs. left

Ask: 'What's the difference between revenue and profit?' Then explain it back in your own words, with one example from your idea.

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 2 — The math of one sale (bridge to Unit 3) **Topic area:** Public communication · pitch craft **Strand focus:** CBM

Objectives

- Write a 30-second elevator pitch that names the customer, the problem, and the price.
- Deliver the pitch live to one peer.
- Self-score against three pitch criteria.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA SL.5.4:** Report on a topic in an organized manner.
- **CCSS-ELA W.5.4:** Produce clear and coherent writing.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Recognize the gap between what you mean and what others hear.

Materials

- Elevator Pitch template (provided).
- Stopwatch (or phone timer).
- Pitch criteria card (3 items): customer named, problem named, price named.
- Cash V5 ("The Pitch Is the Customer's Question") — 2:50.

Vocabulary

- **Pitch** — a short, clear way to tell a customer what you are offering and why they should care.
- **Elevator pitch** — a pitch short enough to give in the time of an elevator ride (about 30 seconds).

Procedure

1. Engage — Cash V5 (~5 min)

Play the video. After: "*What three things does Cash say a pitch has to name?*" Cold-call. Customer. Problem. Price.

2. Model — Two Pitches (~7 min)

Read aloud one bad pitch and one good pitch.

Bad pitch: "*Hi, I have a great idea. Everyone is going to love it. It's a really cool thing. You should buy one!*"

Good pitch: "*Third-graders at our school get bored between recess and pickup time. I make custom paper-craft kits with five activities for three dollars. Want one?*"

Ask: "*Which one names a customer? Which one names a problem? Which one names a price?*" Bad: none. Good: all three.

3. Write — 30-Second Pitch Draft (~15 min)

Students draft their pitch using the template. Required elements:

- **Customer line:** "My customer is _ **who needs** ___."
- **Solution line:** "I make/do _ **for** ___."
- **Price line:** "I charge $_ **because** ___."

Cap at 60 written words; that is roughly 30 seconds spoken.

4. Practice — Pair Delivery (~15 min)

In pairs, students take turns. Partner times the pitch (target: 25–35 seconds) and checks the three criteria. Partner gives one piece of feedback: "*You named two of the three. The one you missed was ___.*" Student revises.

5. Close — Five Volunteers (~8 min)

Five students deliver pitches to the class. Class checks the three criteria. Teacher gives one specific note per pitch (no general praise).

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Sentence frames printed on the template. Allow native-language drafting first. Pair with a strong English speaker for the practice round.
- **IEP/504.** Allow a written pitch read aloud (instead of memorized). Reduce target time to 20–40 seconds. Provide a printed version of the criteria to follow during the partner check.
- **Advanced.** Add a fourth required element: a piece of evidence ("I asked five third-graders and four said they would pay $3"). Introduces evidence-in-pitching, which sets up Grade 7 work.

Assessment

Formative: Walk during practice round; check the three criteria.
Summative: Final pitch performance feeds the Unit 3 anchor artifact.

Closure

Same as #5.

Teacher notes

- A student says "everyone will love it" in the pitch. Coach: "*Can a customer disagree with that? Pick a more specific person.*"
- Avoid telling students their pitch is "great" or "amazing." Cash never says either. Use specifics: "*Your customer line is clear. Your problem line is fuzzy.*"
- **Sensitivity:** No real customer names in pitches. Use "third-graders," "neighbors," "kids in afterschool" — never specific classmate names.

Lesson 7 — Spot the Trick: Persuasion Techniques in Real Ads

CASH ASKS

"*Five ideas beats one idea. Pick the most real-sounding one.*"

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 3 — Persuasion in the wild **Topic area:** Media literacy · persuasion analysis **Strand focus:** ESL

Objectives

- Identify at least 3 persuasive techniques (scarcity, social proof, authority, urgency, fear) in real or realistic kid-aimed ads.
- Distinguish *fact* from *opinion* in 5 ad statements with a one-line reason.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA RI.5.6:** Analyze how multiple accounts of the same event reflect similar and different points of view.
- **CCSS-ELA RI.5.8:** Explain how an author uses reasons and evidence to support points.
- **CASEL Responsible Decision-Making:** Ethical responsibility.

Materials

- 6 kid-aimed ads (real or realistic; provided in program assets — toy, snack, gaming app, lunchbox, school-supply, sneaker).
- "Spot the Trick" worksheet.
- Vocabulary cards (one per technique).
- Three highlighter colors.

Vocabulary

- **Scarcity** — "only 3 left!" Pressure to act fast.
- **Social proof** — "everyone's getting it!"
- **Authority** — "doctors recommend!" or "world's #1!"
- **Urgency** — "today only!"
- **Fear** — "without this, you'll be left behind!"

Procedure

1. Engage — Watch One Ad Together (~5 min)

Project a 30-second commercial (real or scripted). After it plays, ask: "*What did this ad want you to feel? What did it want you to do?*" Pair-share. Two volunteers share.

2. Explain — The Five Techniques (~10 min)

Define each one with a clear example. Hand out vocabulary cards. The principle: ads are designed; once you can name the design, the design loses some of its grip.

3. Practice — Spot the Trick Worksheet (~20 min)

Students go through the 6 ads and identify which technique(s) each uses. For one ad, they write 1 sentence: "*Was this used fairly or to pressure?*" Confer.

4. Fact vs. Opinion (~10 min)

Project 5 statements from the ads:

- "Has 30 grams of protein." (fact)
- "The smartest kids choose this." (opinion)
- "Limited time only — ends Friday." (fact, if true; opinion otherwise)
- "Doctors recommend this brand." (could be fact, if backed by evidence)
- "If you don't have it, you'll feel left out." (opinion / fear-based)

Students mark each F or O and explain in 1 line.

5. Close — One Ad to Watch Out For (~5 min)

Each student writes in the Capstone Journal: "*An ad I'm going to look out for this week is ___ because ___.*"

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Use ads with strong visuals so the language is supported by images. Cognates: *autoridad, escasez, urgencia.*
- **IEP/504.** Reduce to 4 ads. Provide a checklist version with the technique names already listed.
- **Advanced.** Add a 6th technique they hypothesize (humor, nostalgia, identity-belonging) and find an ad using it. Push toward "what makes this ad fair vs. pressuring?"

Assessment

Formative: Worksheet; fact-vs-opinion responses. **Summative:** Feeds the Two-Ad Analysis at the Unit 3 close.

Closure

Same as #5.

Teacher notes

- Some students will defend ads they love. Validate the affection; coach toward "what specifically does it do?" Don't demand they hate the ad.
- Connect to Grade 7 — students who do this work at Grade 5 will hit the persuasion vs. manipulation work in Grade 7 with a strong base.
- **Sensitivity:** Pre-screen any ad you bring in. Avoid ads that target body image, food shaming, or gendered stereotypes.

Lesson 8 — Fact vs. Opinion in Ad Claims

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 3 — Persuasion in the wild **Topic area:** Critical reading of ads · evidence-based judgment **Strand focus:** ESL, BAVC

Objectives

- Sort 10 ad claims into *fact*, *opinion*, or *fact-claim-without-evidence*.
- Write a one-sentence reason for each sort.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA RI.5.8:** Explain how an author uses reasons and evidence to support points.
- **CEE Standard 2 (Buying Goods and Services), Grade 8:** Comparison shopping — kid version (price + quality).
- **CASEL Responsible Decision-Making:** Considering consequences of being misled.

Materials

- "Fact, Opinion, or Unproven?" sorting card set (10 cards).
- Three poster sheets labeled FACT · OPINION · UNPROVEN CLAIM.
- Capstone Journal.

Vocabulary

- **Fact** — something that can be checked and is true.
- **Opinion** — what someone thinks or feels; cannot be proven true or false.
- **Unproven claim** — a statement that sounds like a fact but has no evidence behind it.

Procedure

1. Engage — The "Doctor-Recommended" Trap (~7 min)

Read aloud: "*4 out of 5 dentists recommend this gum.*" Ask: "*Is that a fact or an opinion?*" Class will be split.

Coach: it sounds like a fact (it has a number!). But to be a real fact, you would need to know which dentists, how many were asked, and what the question was. Without that, it is an *unproven claim* — a fact-shaped sentence with no evidence.

2. Explain — Three Categories (~8 min)

Define the three. Stress that *unproven claim* is the trickiest. It looks like a fact but cannot be checked.

3. Practice — Sort the Cards (~20 min)

In pairs, students sort the 10 cards onto the three poster sheets. Sample cards:

- "This snack has 30 grams of protein." (fact)
- "This is the best snack ever." (opinion)
- "Smart kids eat this." (unproven)
- "Costs $2.99." (fact)
- "Loved by millions." (unproven)
- "Lasts up to 8 hours." (unproven, if not tested)
- "I think this color is cool." (opinion)
- "Made in the United States." (fact, if true)
- "The fastest growing brand of the year." (unproven)
- "Recommended by 9 out of 10 kids who tried it." (unproven without source)

After 12 minutes, walk the room and read posters together. Where did pairs disagree?

4. Apply — Write a Reason (~10 min)

In the Capstone Journal, students pick three cards from the sort and write one sentence each explaining why they put each in that category.

5. Close — One Claim You'd Re-Check (~5 min)

Each student writes: "*One claim I'd want to re-check before believing is ___ because ___.*"

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Pre-teach the three terms with cognates (*hecho, opinión*). Allow native-language reasoning on the journal entry; require English on at least one of the three.
- **IEP/504.** Reduce to 6 cards. Pre-printed reason-stem ("This is a ___ because ___").
- **Advanced.** Add a 4th category — *misleading-but-technically-true* claims (e.g., "Now with 50% more!" — more of what?). Find one ad that uses this.

Assessment

Formative: Walk during sort; watch which pairs struggle to distinguish unproven from fact. **Summative:** Reasons in journal feed Two-Ad Analysis Capstone artifact.

Closure

Same as #5.

Teacher notes

- A student says "all ads are lies." Coach: "*That is too easy. Some ads have real evidence. Your job is to spot which.*"
- Connect to the year's spine question: "*How do you know somebody actually wants it?*" The same evidence muscle that helps with customers helps with ads.

- **Sensitivity:** Avoid examples that name real currently-marketed products in a way that students could carry home as criticism of family purchases. Use generic "Brand X" framings.

Lesson 9 — Inventory Tracker: Practice Day Before the Market

CASH SAYS

"*First tries get something wrong. The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.*"

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 60 minutes (block) **Unit:** 4 — Run the market **Topic area:** Operations practice · simple tracking systems **Strand focus:** OSO

Objectives

- Use a simple inventory tracker (start, sold, ending, restock) for a one-period classroom practice market.
- Explain a discrepancy between expected and actual ending inventory.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-Math 5.NBT.B.7:** Add, subtract, multiply, and divide decimals.
- **C3 D2.Eco.7.3-5:** Explain how profits influence sellers in markets.
- **CCSS-ELA W.5.4:** Produce clear and coherent writing.

Materials

- Inventory Tracker template (provided).
- Classroom-currency tokens (or play money).
- 5–10 simple sample products per booth (paper crafts, drawings, small samples).

- Stopwatch.

Vocabulary

- **Inventory** — the things you have to sell.
- **Sale** — a transaction where the customer pays and receives the product.
- **Discrepancy** — the difference between what should be there and what is.

Procedure

1. Engage — Why Track? (~7 min)

Tell a 90-second story: a kid runs a craft booth for two hours, makes "good money," but at the end realizes they have no idea how many items they sold or how much profit they made. Ask: "*What is the problem?*" Surface that without tracking, you cannot improve.

2. Explain — The Four Columns (~8 min)

Walk through the tracker:

- **Start.** How many you have at opening.
- **Sold.** How many you sold.
- **Ending.** How many you have at closing. (Start − Sold.)
- **Restock.** How many you added during the period (if any).

Worked example: Start 20, Sold 12, Restock 0 → Ending should be 8. If actual ending is 7, the discrepancy is 1 — maybe a sample, maybe an error, maybe a give-away.

3. We Do — Run a 15-Minute Practice Market (~25 min)

Set up 4–5 booths around the room. Half the class is sellers; half is customers (using classroom currency). Sellers fill in their tracker live as they make sales. After 15 minutes, switch — buyers become sellers and sellers become buyers.

4. You Do — Reconcile the Tracker (~12 min)

Each former seller reconciles their tracker:

- Did Start − Sold = Ending? If not, what is the discrepancy?
- What is one explanation? (Gave a sample, miscounted, lost one, etc.)
- Compute total revenue (Sold × Price). Subtract total cost. What is profit?

5. Close — One-Sentence Lesson (~8 min)

Each student writes: "*One thing I learned about tracking inventory today is ___.*"

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Sentence frames for the discrepancy explanation. Vocabulary cards for *inventory, sale, discrepancy.* Cognates: *inventario, venta, discrepancia.*
- **IEP/504.** Pre-printed tracker with column headers and one example row filled in. Calculator allowed.
- **Advanced.** Add a fifth column: *Per-unit profit*. Compute total profit two ways (sum of per-unit profit; revenue − cost) and check they match.

Assessment

Formative: Walk during the market; check trackers in real time.
Summative: Tracker performance feeds Market Day readiness.

Closure

Same as #5.

Teacher notes

- A student's discrepancy is large (10+ items). Coach: "*Walk me through what happened minute by minute.*" Often the issue is samples or trades that did not get logged.
- Some students will resist tracking ("it slows me down"). Reframe: "*This is the part that lets you learn from today. Without it, you cannot improve.*"

- **Sensitivity:** Use classroom-currency or paper-token transactions. Real money creates pressure for students from low-income families and is unnecessary for the learning goal.

Lesson 10 — Classroom Market Day + Post-Market Debrief (Capstone)

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 90 minutes (Market Day) + 50 minutes (Debrief next session) **Unit:** 4 — Run the market **Topic area:** Capstone performance · debrief writing **Strand focus:** LRCI, LTO, MFL, OSO (all four strands braid)

Objectives

- Run a small business at the Classroom Market Day for a real audience.
- Track inventory and sales using the year's tracker.
- Write a Post-Market Debrief: 2 items each in *what worked / what flopped / what I would change*.

Standards alignment

- **Jump$tart Standard 1 (Spending and Saving), Benchmark 4-4:** Develop a basic spending plan with set income and prioritized expenses.
- **CCSS-Math 5.NBT.B.7:** Add, subtract, multiply, and divide decimals.
- **CCSS-ELA W.5.4:** Produce clear and coherent writing.
- **C3 D2.Eco.7.3-5:** Explain how profits influence sellers in markets.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness + Self-Management:** Reflecting on performance.

Materials

- Each student's Pricing Decision worksheet, pitch, and Inventory Tracker (carried forward all year).
- Booth setup (table, sign, samples, classroom-currency or token system).

- Audience: another class, families, or younger students. Schedule in advance.
- Post-Market Debrief template (provided).
- Cash V8 ("Plans Meet Reality") — 2:55, played the morning of Market Day to settle nerves.

Vocabulary

- **Market** — a place where buyers and sellers meet.
- **Debrief** — a reflection after an event to figure out what to do next time.
- **What worked / what flopped / what I would change** — the year's three reflection prompts.

Procedure

Day 1 — Market Day (~90 min)

1. Pre-Market Huddle (~10 min)

Play Cash V8. Settle nerves. Re-read the rubric. Each student/pair has their tracker, their pitch, and their pricing memo on hand. Remind: "*The market is the work. The debrief is the grade. Either way, you are learning.*"

2. Setup (~10 min)

Booths set up. Last-minute pitch practice with a partner.

3. Market Open (~50 min)

Audience flows through. Students deliver their pitches, make sales, track inventory in real time. Teacher walks the room and confers with stuck students.

4. Market Close + Tally (~20 min)

Booths close. Students reconcile their trackers: Start − Sold = Ending? Compute total revenue, total cost, profit. Identify discrepancies.

Day 2 — Debrief (~50 min)

5. Engage — Cash Voice in the Air (~5 min)

Read aloud Cash's debrief frame: "*What worked. What flopped. What I would change. Two each. Be specific. 'It went okay' is not a debrief.*"

6. Write — Post-Market Debrief (~25 min)

Students fill in the template:

- **What worked (2 items).** Specific. With a number or a quote.
- **What flopped (2 items).** Specific. Same.
- **What I would change (2 items).** Specific. Connected to one item in worked or flopped.
- **One sentence on profit:** "I made $***. That was [more / less / about] what I expected because*** ."

7. Pair Read-Aloud (~10 min)

In pairs, students read each other's debriefs and ask: "*Could you be more specific about what changed?*" Revise.

8. Close — Year-End Reflection (~10 min)

In the Capstone Journal, one final entry: "*One thing I now know about money, pricing, or profit that I did not know in September is ___.*" This is filed as the year's closing artifact.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Sentence frames for every debrief section. Allow native-language drafting; English required on the final filed copy. Pair on the read-aloud step.
- **IEP/504.** Reduce to 1 item per category (instead of 2). Allow voice-recorded debrief. For Market Day itself, offer a "money keeper" partner role to any student anxious about leading sales.
- **Advanced.** Add a fourth section: "*What I would change if I were running this for a real business next month.*" Pushes toward Grade 6 systems thinking.

Assessment

Formative: Real-time tracker check during Market Day. Read debriefs during writing block. **Summative:** Market Day + Debrief is the year's Capstone artifact. Scored using Rubric 5 (Reflection Writing) at 3-5 setting plus Rubric 1 (Business Plan) at simplified Grade 4-5 setting.

Closure

Same as #8.

Teacher notes

- Some students will sell out fast and feel like winners. Coach: "*Could you have priced higher and made more profit? Was the price too low?*" Selling out is not always good news.
- Some students will sell nothing. This is the most valuable learning opportunity in the year. Coach gently: "*What would you change about your pitch? Your price? Your booth?*" Frame zero sales as evidence, not failure.
- The debrief is where the grade lives. A student with a great market and a vague debrief scores lower than a student with a hard market and a sharp debrief. Tell students this in advance.
- **Sensitivity:** Make sure no student is shamed for a weak market. The debrief is the assessment, not the sales total. Reinforce this norm publicly.

End-of-year teacher self-check

Did most of my students this year:

- Compute and revise a profit number from real cost and price inputs? (Yes/No)
- Set a price using a target margin and defend the choice? (Yes/No)
- Identify at least three persuasive techniques in real ads? (Yes/No)

- Run a Market Day booth and write a specific debrief? (Yes/No)

If three of those four are yes, the year worked. If fewer, look at which routine slipped — usually the per-sale math in Unit 2 or the debrief writing in Unit 4.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Grade 5 worked examples and misconceptions

Three target-margin worked examples (add to Lesson 4 — Pricing with a Margin)

The original lesson teaches the formula. Add three full worked examples at three different margin targets.

Worked example A — 40% target margin on cookies

Cost per cookie: $0.30. Target margin: 40% (you want to keep 40 cents of every dollar). Price = Cost ÷ (1 − 0.40) = $0.30 ÷ 0.60 = **$0.50 per cookie.**

Check: at $0.50 price, profit per cookie = $0.20. As fraction of price: $0.20 ÷ $0.50 = 0.40 = 40%. Correct.

Worked example B — 50% target margin on bracelets

Cost per bracelet: $0.50. Target margin: 50%. Price = $0.50 ÷ (1 − 0.50) = $0.50 ÷ 0.50 = **$1.00 per bracelet.**

Check: profit per bracelet = $0.50. As fraction of price: $0.50 ÷ $1.00 = 50%. Correct.

Worked example C — 25% target margin on tutoring

Cost per session: $1.00 (printouts + sticker). Target margin: 25%. Price = $1.00 ÷ (1 − 0.25) = $1.00 ÷ 0.75 = **$1.33** (round to $1.50 in real life).

Check: at $1.33 price, profit per session = $0.33. As fraction of price: 25%. Correct.

Coach the pattern: "*Higher target margin = higher price. The customer might or might not pay. That's a choice. The math tells you the* minimum *price for that margin; the customer tells you the* maximum."

Common Misconceptions (Grade 5)

KID BELIEF	WHAT'S ACTUALLY TRUE	HOW TO COACH
"Profit is whatever I have at the end of the day."	Profit = revenue − cost. If "home" supplies were borrowed, count them at their real cost.	"*Tell me what every supply would cost if you bought it. Add it up. That's your cost. Now subtract from revenue.*"
"If I sell more, I'll always make more money."	Only if your contribution margin is positive. If you sell at less than cost, more sales = bigger loss.	"*What if you sold each cup for $0.20 but each cup costs $0.30? More cups means more loss.*"
"I should pick the highest price the math allows."	The math gives you a *minimum* price. The customer's willingness to pay sets the *ceiling*. The right price is in between.	"*At $5 a cup, would you buy lemonade? At $0.50? Where's the line for you?*"
"Ads are just designed to inform."	Ads are designed to make you feel something — and then act. Once you can name the technique, the technique loses some grip.	Show two ads. "*What does this ad want you to feel? What does it want you to do?*"

ROUND 2 PATCH — Common Misconceptions (Grade 5)

COMMON KID-BELIEF	REALITY	COACHING MOVE
"Higher price = more profit."	Higher price can mean fewer customers. The total profit depends on price *and* volume.	Show three pricing scenarios for the same lemonade: $1/cup × 20 cups = $20; $2/cup × 8 cups = $16; $5/cup × 2 cups = $10. Higher price, *less* profit.
"If I add 40% margin, I add 40% to the cost."	A 40% target margin means *price minus cost = 40% of the price* (gross margin). Not 40% of cost. Two formulas; teach both, name the difference.	Walk through: Cost = $1. If margin is "40% of cost," price = $1.40. If margin is "40% of price" (gross margin), price = $1 / (1 − 0.40) = $1.67. The second is the founder formula.
"If the ad says it works, it works."	Ads use scarcity, bandwagon, authority — three persuasion techniques that *say* something works without proving it. Look for evidence, not enthusiasm.	Show 3 kid-aimed ads. For each, name the persuasion technique used and what evidence is missing.
"Profit on Day 1 means the business is doing well."	One day is not a trend. Three days, ten days — patterns. Day 1 is data, not destiny.	Run a Market Day debrief that asks: "Was Day 1 typical? What might be different on Day 2?"
"If I rotate roles, I cant get good at any of them."	Rotating roles in a multi-day project teaches *what each role needs from the others*. The point is empathy, not expertise.	Have students write one sentence per role: "What I now know the [marketer/CEO/money keeper] needs from the others."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Worked Examples for Target-Margin Pricing

Cost of one cup: $0.50. Target gross margin: 40%.

Worked Example 1 (target gross margin formula). Price = Cost / (1 − Margin) = $0.50 / 0.60 = $0.833 → round to $0.85. Coaching: "85¢ price; 50¢ cost; 35¢ left per cup. 35/85 = 41% gross margin (close to target)."

Worked Example 2 (target margin = 50%). Price = $0.50 / 0.50 = $1.00. Coaching: "Higher target margin → higher price. The customer has to be willing to pay $1."

Worked Example 3 (target margin = 25%). Price = $0.50 / 0.75 = $0.67 → round to $0.70. Coaching: "Lower target margin → lower price. More customers might buy. *But* youre making less per cup. Lets compute total profit at 30 cups vs. 50 cups."

Multi-volume profit at $0.85 price (Example 1): - 10 cups: revenue $8.50, cost $5, profit $3.50. - 25 cups: revenue $21.25, cost $12.50, profit $8.75. - 50 cups: revenue $42.50, cost $25, profit $17.50.

Anti-example. Student writes: "Cost $0.50, want 40% margin, price = $0.70." Coaching: "$0.70 − $0.50 = $0.20. $0.20 / $0.70 = 28%. Thats not 40%. Use the formula."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Multi-Class Branching Scenario (Grade 5)

"Two stands at the same fair, same product, different prices." A 3-day branching scenario.

- **Day 1.** Stand A sells lemonade at $0.50/cup. Stand B sells lemonade at $1.50/cup. Both have the same cost ($0.30). Whose math is right? The answer is *both* — at different volumes and different customer beliefs. Walk through Stand A: 50 cups × $0.50 = $25 revenue, $15 cost, $10

profit. Walk through Stand B: 12 cups × $1.50 = $18 revenue, $3.60 cost, $14.40 profit.

- **Day 2.** Whats Stand B doing differently? (Better location? Premium ingredients? Customers willing to pay more?) Run a 30-second elevator pitch for Stand B that *justifies* the price.
- **Day 3.** Run a 30-second pitch for Stand A that justifies *its* price (volume, accessibility, the $0.50 customer).

This branching practices BAVC (value), MFL (margin + multi-volume profit), CBM (30-second pitch), LRCI (debrief).

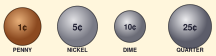
ROUND 2 PATCH — Teacher Move Set (Grade 5)

- **Student sets a price below cost.** Say: "Lets check — if it costs you 50¢ and you sell at 40¢, whats your profit?" Walk through: "Negative 10¢. You *lose* 10¢ each. The more you sell, the more you lose."
- **Student writes a 60-second pitch instead of 30.** Say: "Cut by half. Whats the most important sentence? Whats the customer? Whats the price?" Use a stopwatch.
- **Student sees a kid-aimed ad and says "thats just an ad."** Say: "What persuasion technique did they use? Scarcity (only today!), bandwagon (everyone has it!), or authority (a star says so!). Name the one."
- **Student rotates roles but writes the same reflection for all three.** Say: "What did the *marketer* notice that the *CEO* didnt? What did the *money keeper* worry about that the *marketer* didnt?" Force the contrast.
- **Student says "my Market Day was a flop, so the whole project failed."** Say: "Lets debrief — what worked, what flopped, what youd change. Two each. The flop is data."

FROM CASH

Money in, money out, money left

Revenue is loud. Cost is sneaky. Profit is what is actually yours. Track all three or you don't really know what's happening.



KEEP IT REAL

Real customers. Real money. Real lessons.

Every page in this book points back to one habit: ask a real person, listen to the real answer, count the real numbers. The rest is decoration.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What Grade 5 hits

This curriculum book aligns to the following K-12 standards. See the *Master Standards Alignment Map* for the full grade-band crosswalk.

Jump$tart 5
Spending and saving - budgeting and cost-of-goods.

CEE NS8
Role of price in markets, supply and demand.

CCSS-MATH 5.NBT
Place value, decimals, multi-step money problems.

CCSS-ELA W.5.1
Write opinion pieces - pitch with evidence.

CASEL Self-Management
Goal-setting and planning.

C3 D2.Eco.7.3-5
Explain how profit motivates producers.

FROM CASH

One last thing

"*Revenue is loud. What's left is what you keep.*"

- CASH, GRADE 5

Revenue is loud. What's left is what you keep. — Cash

Cash to Company • Grade 5 • Curriculum Book